Disaster and Emergency Preparedness Assessment System

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Status:	Under Consideration
Date:	4/23/2026

Letter of Inquiry

Application/Form Preview

Cisco Support

Type of Cisco Support	Cisco Funds

Proposal Contact

Are you able to successfully find your Organization Profile in the Benevity Cause Portal?	No

Organization Contacts	First Name	Last Name	Job Title	Email Address	Phone Number
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Organization Information

Organization Legal Name	Adaptive Solutions Collaborative, Inc.
Country	United States of America (The)
Federal Tax ID or Employer Identification Number	39-4441893
(IRS): Non-profit Organization Status	501(c)(3) Public Charity
(IRS): Organization Legal Name	Adaptive Solutions Collaborative in C
(IRS): Organization Address	15113 Watergate Rd
(IRS): Organization City	Silver Spring
(IRS): Organization State	MD
(IRS): Organization Zip Code	20905
Address	15113 Watergate Road
City	Silver Spring
State	Maryland
Zip	20905
Organization URL	www.asci.solutions
Organization Phone	(301) 466-0866

Organization Social Media Presence	Handle	Account	Profile Link (URL)
Facebook			
Instagram			
LinkedIn			
X			
Other			

Organization Summary

Mission Statement	Our mission is to use advanced and disruptive technologies for humanitarian purposes by collaborating with organizations that bring meaningful challenges, domain knowledge, and mission alignment.
Overview of Organization	In response to recurrence of disastrous events and emergencies, the US Government passed the Disaster Recovery Reform Act (DRRA) in 2018 that requires pertinent US Government Agencies to "complete a national preparedness assessment of capability gaps at each level of the Federal, State and local jurisdictions". Following the passage of DRRA, FEMA developed a set of assessment products including the National Threats and Identification Risks and Assessment (THIRA) which defines a jurisdiction's full capability requirements to handle all possible threats and hazards and the Stakeholder Preparedness Review (SPR) which identifies each jurisdiction's current capability. FEMA developed THIRA as a toolkit using a structured language with a standard format based on specific scenarios to describe target capabilities, current capabilities, and gaps to support disaster operations and assess the level of preparedness of jurisdictions of interest. Reliance on structured language based on scenarios on impacts of threats on capability targets has some limitations because the scenarios may not provide an exhaustive list to capture all risks. Subject matter experts from the US Air Force Disaster Preparedness Program (under the auspices of the Center for Global Health Engagement [CGHE] Disaster Preparedness Program [DPP]) have also developed 200+ best practice questions and preparedness rating principles to assess the capabilities of selected sectors and jurisdictions using a whole-of-society preparedness model. The US government and the WHO have also developed the Joint External Evaluation (JEE) tool for independent evaluation of levels of preparedness for pandemics and other emergencies. The CGHE and the JEE tools require manually answering best practice questions to generate the ratings. SEGMA, LLC – in collaboration with members of the ASCI team – developed the Disaster and Emergency Preparedness Assessment System (DEPAS) to address the limitations of THIRA, CGHE, and the JEE models, and ASCI, an early stage nonprofit, established in September 2025, has been granted an open license to use DEPAS. Based on AI-enabled natural language understanding algorithms and text analytics, DEPAS extracts key information from planning and preparedness documents, and compares them to known best practices. It then rates the jurisdiction's level of readiness to respond to disasters and emergencies, supporting subsequent resolution of capability gaps. DEPAS can process both structured and unstructured documents and supports a whole-of-society approach to risk assessment with a focus on the risks related to seven sectors: the Administration, Communication infrastructure; Disaster response; Health management; Logistics, the Civilian-Military Collaboration, and Cybersecurity. To improve the gap analysis process, DEPAS efficiently and effectively compares reported capability status against best practices using natural language processing (NLP) technologies. A jurisdiction's current capability is measured by the percentage of correct (preferred) answers to the best practice questions while the gaps are based on questions with deficient answers. The underlying NLP technologies used for DEPAS can be adapted for broad uses in domains that require automated assistance of natural language based analytics. A semi-automated question answering system, it can improve productivity (5 fold) generating ratings in 8-12 hours instead of 40+, thus enabling weekly updates. It also enables human validation of machine generated answers to promote trust in emergency preparedness ratings. Large language models such as ChatGPT are inadequate for this highly specialized domain due to their relative limitation in language understanding, deep understanding of context, and sparse training data. Our team has tested DEPAS to assess the level of readiness for the cities of Baltimore, MD and NY city, identified capability gaps, and developed collaboration strategies to close the gaps. Several players in emergency management primarily provide tools and services to support individuals and communities to prepare and respond to disaster at the micro levels. The players include: ESRI, Inc.; Honeywell International Inc., IBM Corporation, Lockheed Martin Corporation, and Motorola Solutions, Inc., with product offerings for mass notification, surveillance, traffic management, first responder tools, satellite phones, while major universities' Global Health Institutes conduct research and offer training on disaster preparedness. Our contribution to disaster preparedness operates at the macro level with the capability to manage a wide range of risk categories (catastrophic, systemic, and/or emerging) that aid in focusing investments for building capacity and managing a variety of hazards and threats, thereby providing a comprehensive and risk-based measure of disaster and emergency preparedness. ASCI uses innovative technologies to lower barriers to innovation, empower collaborators, and develop solutions that increase economic opportunity, improve community well-being, promote disaster preparedness, and support survivability and resilience of critical systems.
Organization Continents of Operation	North & Central America
Organization Countries of Operation	United States of America (The)
Percent of Organization Staff In-Country	76 - 100%

Program Summary

Cisco investment portfolio	Crisis Response
Focus Area within Crisis Response	Disaster Preparedness and Recovery

Program/Proposal Title	Disaster and Emergency Preparedness Assessment System
Statement of Need	Communities in many under-served jurisdictions are increasingly exposed to disproportional threats from insufficiencies in disaster preparedness, Cybersecurity and mitigation of climate change impacts. At-risk populations often lack timely access to actionable risk information and practical training which may be mismatched to real-world conditions. For many in these communities, infrastructure is fragile, unreliable, or nonexistent; they experience disproportionate exposure to risk without proportional support resulting in cognitive and emotional overload during crises. We are developing solutions to fill the gaps between a jurisdiction current level of preparedness and the target level based on best practices using AI-enabled natural language processing question answering technologies.
Program Summary	We are dedicated to empowering collaborators and developing innovative technologies in AI-enabled disaster preparedness, survivable and secure communication networks, and other solutions that strengthen community resilience through technology and education by developing resilient Infrastructures which aligns with Cisco's commitment to advancing equitable and sustainable solutions through technology innovation to improve human lives in under-served communities. For example, using DEPAS: Disaster and Emergency Preparedness Assessment System (our semi-automated disaster preparedness gap analysis tool) can speed up the assessment / rating process five-fold (e.g., 8-12 hours v. 40+ hours per jurisdiction) for a target population in Baltimore MD, (74% minorities) while also improving accuracy and coverage for seven key sectors of the society, i.e., The Administration, Disaster response, Communications, Health management, Logistics, Civilian-military collaboration, and Cyber security. DEPAS can be applied to other jurisdictions, (local, or state throughout the country). Proposed budget: DEPAS could be rolled out and applied to 2 jurisdictions (Baltimore City, MD and New York City, NY) over 12 months for $75K .
Summary Impact Statement	ASCI uses innovative technologies to lower barriers to innovation, empower collaborators, and develop solutions that increase economic opportunity, improve community well-being, promote disaster preparedness, and support resilience of critical systems.
Leveraging Technology	The Resilient Infrastructures Initiative is designed to leverage technology-driven solutions to address humanitarian challenges such as: (i) Disaster and Emergency Preparedness. This system provides a comprehensive measure of emergency preparedness using best-practice questions to assess an entity's preparedness posture and capability gaps for climate-vulnerable communities. It is evidence-based, data-driven and flexible to accommodate natural language planning and preparedness documents that supports human validation of machine generated answers to promote trust in preparedness ratings; (ii) Designing for Survivable and Resilient Critical Communication Infrastructures. This system improves communications reliability to allow continuous functionality of infrastructure during disasters and emergencies to protect lives and property. The platform employs Particle Swarm Optimization (PSO) algorithm, a population-based strategy that employs swarms of agents in a large problem space to solve problems with multiple objectives to reach an optimum solution to protect the network; and threat feeds to support a predictive game-theoretic threat management system. This system automatically responds to threat conditions and proactively defends complex communication networks and critical infrastructures, such as emergency communication systems and health networks; (iii) AI for Public Good: Game-based learning and adaptive tutoring for increased literacy and skill development in targeted areas to democratize education and economic opportunities for under-served communities (e.g., STEM, Statistics). This system uses student modeling, difficulty factor analysis, progressive disclosure techniques, expert modeling of problem solving (based on both curated data and a production rule system), and integration of multiple pedagogical techniques;

Cisco Policy Confirmation

Non-Discrimination Confirmation	I Confirm that the organization I represent complies with the above-stated policy in its entirety
Lobbying Restriction Confirmation	I Confirm
Religious Proselytizing Restriction Confirmation	I Confirm
Non-Support of Violence/Terrorism Confirmation	I Confirm (Option A)
Board Review/Approval Confirmation	I Confirm
Accuracy Certification Confirmation	I Confirm
Acceptance of Review Confirmation	I Confirm

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